ISIS

The November 2015 Paris terror attacks followed by the devastating terror explosions in the Brussels airport (March 2016) show the emergence of a new pivot of terror alongside the existing ones – the ISIS. It would be too far-stretched to say that the Al-Qaeda has become non-functional, but currently the focus is on increased activities of the ISIS.

The ISIS is the acronym for the Jihadi militant outfit who calls themselves as Islamic State of Syria and Iraq. By mid-2014, the ISIS took control of Mosul, Fallujah and Tirkit. They have extended their activities into Libya too and has established a strong foothold in Sitre.

An international coalition of almost 60 countries has been fighting against the ISIS since 2014. The USA is taking a leading role in these actions against ISIS. It is leading two coalitions carrying out air strikes targeting ISIS in Iraq and Syria and Libya. Britain, France and Russia are among other major coalition partners. Germany's lower House of Parliament also gave a green signal for Germany to join the international coalition against ISIS at the end of 2015.

In early 2016, the US-backed forces were successful in pushing back the ISIS from the Syrian town of Shadadi. Iraq has also launched military offensive to reclaim its largest city of Mosul. No solution is in sight and terrorism and counter-terrorism activities will go on, but sufferers will be innocent people who are fleeing their countries and taking refuge in other countries especially European countries. Europe is experiencing the tragedy of 'boat people' from Syria and Iraq.